



Extreme cycling

Land

Trek 8900 Pro USA 1990



Frame made of carbon fiber tubes fitted to aluminum joints

Suspension allows front forks to telescope down into lower tubes when hitting bumps



Specialized Stumpjumper
USA 1981

Gear changer on the handlebar helps select between the bicycle's 15 gears

Single gear cog on rear wheel

2ft-6in- (6.4-cm-) wide tire for great grip in sand, dirt, and mud

Raleigh Kool Max UK 2000s



Some mountain bicycles have up to **30 gears** to speed over different conditions.

Fat Chance Yo-Eddy

USA 1991



Trek 6000 USA 1991

Toe straps secure rider's feet on pedals

Shock absorber cushions bumps



Hydraulic (fluid-operated) disk brakes

Stumpjumper FSR Pro USA 2004

While ordinary bicycles can be ridden off-road, their smooth tires and slender frames are not suitable for rough stuff. When bikers in the USA began redesigning bicycles for better off-road performances in the 1970s, mountain biking was born!

The first mountain bicycle made on a large scale was the **Specialized Stumpjumper**. Only 500 were initially produced, but they started a revolution. Soon, many manufacturers came up with their own designs. The **Trek 6000** had a lightweight, all-aluminum frame, while the **Trek**